

Vertigo



Photo Campsite with view of Kaikoura (photo: Jordan Poste)

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club - Wellington Section

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Section News



Section Nights

Welcome to the last (late) Vertigo for 2014. There are no section nights in December or January. Have a great Christmas and New Year and enjoy some fantastic summer climbing. We'll be looking forward to some stories and photos for Vertigo in the new year.

The next section night will be held on the second Monday in February – this will most likely be a BBQ. Details including venue to be decided and confirmed via email.



Details of the committee members for 2014 / 2015 will be advised by email after a meeting of old and new committee members in December.

Section Nights are at the Tararua Tramping Club clubrooms, 4 Moncrieff Street, Mount Victoria, Wellington on the second Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings start 8.00 pm with tea & coffee afterwards

Upcoming Trips and Courses

Summer Rock 2015

17 Feb - 19 Apr



Learn rock climbing



- 5 indoor sessions
- Progress your movements at Baring Head
- One weekend on rock around lake Taupo
- One weekend leading on volcanic rock at Wharepapa South



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Registration opened

More info at: wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Trip Report

Te Ao Whekere 7-9 November

Jordan Poste

Since attending the Snowcraft course and the Whangaehu hut re-opening on Ruapehu my partner and I were pumped to get out and take on another Alpine challenge. This came in the form of a peak called Te Ao Whekere, the second highest peak in the seaward Kaikouras at 2,590m. Dan Pringle stepped up as the trip leader and got the ball rolling on this mission and he was joined by Vincent Zintzen as the assistant trip leader. The other participants that rounded out the group were Sophie, Richard, Cécile, Helen, Jenna and myself.

The trip started with a ferry breakdown forcing our departure from Wellington to be delayed a couple hours. Instead of driving to a campsite near the start of the route we instead bedded down for the night in Picton and got up early to drive to Jordan Stream the next day. The Nelson-Marlborough section also joined this expedition and set off shortly after us at about 9am. With 14 people from three NZAC sections, this was a real club trip!

Navigating up the river bed involved criss-crossing back and forth through the stream. Many of us tried to come up with dry crossing options at first but it didn't take long for everyone to accept the fact that we were all going to have wet feet for this journey.

After a couple hours working our way up the stream we encountered our first two setbacks. The Nelson section has passed us and because some of their members had previously done this climb we followed them in overshooting the scree slope turn off. After backtracking down the stream it also became apparent that Cécile wasn't going to be able to join us as she had hyperextended her knee on the way up and it was limiting her ability to fully extend her leg. Vincent and Cécile proceeded to work their way back down to the cars while the rest of the group started their journey up the scree.



The scree eventually gave way to scrub and brush which proved to be even more of a challenge. On hands and knees we were now putting our faith in some blades of grass and twiggy bushes to support our weight. While I have to admit it was kind of fun I was also cursing myself for packing a significant amount of camera gear that felt like a counterweight pulling me off the side of the slope. Eventually we gained the ridge which felt great until we realized that the ridge itself was pretty darn steep. The next couple hours were spent climbing the loosest rock I've ever climbed. The questionable grass we were relying on before to support us suddenly seemed like a much better option to loose flaky boulders. Every 5 or 10 minutes one of us would yell "rock" or we'd see a boulder go screaming down the slope next to us until it smashed into something, shattering into a million pieces, echoing across the valley.

In spite of all the craziness this climb was wicked cool. The group was having a great time and our only real concern was our pace. We had hoped to get to a campsite at 2,200m but it was already 4pm and at the pace we were going we wouldn't arrive at the first campsite at 1,800m until 6pm. I'm not keen to admit it as I'm not normally the "slow one" in the group but my decision to carry the extra weight combined with the fact that many in the group were very fit left me at the back of the pack, and for the last hour of the climb I really had to push hard.



Arriving at camp at 6pm the Nelson-Marlborough group had already set up. The campsite was amazing with a beautiful perspective on the horseshoe ridgeline to the summit and behind us Kaikoura and the sea. Quite possibly one of the most beautiful campsites I've ever seen. After digging some platforms in the snow for our tents, eating dinner and melting some snow we hastily retired for the night.



We woke the next day to the sounds of our alarms at 3:30am. It was going to be a true alpine start! Sophie turned out to be the master alpine planner of the group and hatched a scheme to start walking at 4am with a 7:30am summit time, 10:00am return to the camp and a goal to return to the car by 3pm (4pm at the latest). This was all necessary in order to catch the 7pm ferry in Picton and as it turned out Sophie was pretty much BANG ON with every one of her predicted times.

The weather for this trip was PERFECT, no clouds, little wind and a full moon to light our way. Although we started at 4:15am with headlamps we could have gone without. The snow was a good crusty consistency for walking and since we were traveling along a ridge there were only a few spots that carried any avalanche risk. Watching the sunrise behind us as we climbed our way towards the peak might just be one of my favourite moments since moving to New Zealand over a year ago. I was worried I might be totally drained from the day before but the whole experience filled me with energy and I almost felt like running to the summit.



After a few fun front point sections we made it to the summit at 7:45am (only because we left at 4:15am instead of the target 4am). The group shared some cheers of celebration, pats on the back and a few photos. This was a true team effort with everyone taking turns leading and encouraging each other on. Richard being the strongest in the group graciously took on extra weight throughout the trip to help even the load and keep a steady team pace. The sense of accomplishment at the top felt incredible but was soon replaced with a sense of urgency to get down to the cars on time so we wouldn't miss our ferry.





With the snow softening up we shed our crampons and did a few bum-slides on the way back to camp. A quick breakfast/lunch while packing up camp and we were on our way down the ridge. This may have been the most difficult and dangerous part as down climbing this section knocked loose a few rocks. We had to break the climb up into sections and go one at a time to avoid knocking rocks on the people below us. On a couple occasions basketball sized boulders came whizzing by us – not somewhere I'd be comfortable hanging out for any length of time.

Once through boulder alley we raced down the scree to the stream in no time and were back to car at exactly 4pm. Met by Vincent and Cécile we were all together again and made our way back to Picton, which was quickly followed by everyone passing out for the return trip to Wellington. This was one of coolest experiences I've had in New Zealand and I can't wait for more amazing climbs with the club!

Te Ao Whekere (2,598m) via Jordan Stream (Grade 1) 7-9 November. Cécile Glorot, Helen Curtis, Jordan Poste (report and pics), Jenna Cock, Sophie Guérault, Richard Bell, Dan Pringle, Vincent Zintzen.

Notices

Rescue Beacons

Now that the outdoor season is well under way it is timely to give a special thought to Personal Safety when out in the Wild. I think we all know that with the easy availability of today's technology there is just no valid reason not to carry a Personal Locator Beacon (PLB) with you on a trip whether you are in a group or on your own.

International Mountain Day 11 December 2014 - Mountain Farming and Protection



[UIAA - Mountain Day 2014](#)

The UIAA is putting together a webpage for this year's event. They would like to focus on mountain protection, therefore, any article, video, or photo which is related to protection of the mountain environment is most welcome. Please send this information to valerie.thoeni@theuiaa.org

Mountain Farming is the theme chosen for this year's celebration of International Mountain Day. The day is an opportunity to raise awareness about mountain agriculture, which is predominantly a family farming activity. Mountain farming has been adapted through the centuries and continues to be a positive model of sustainability, integrating innovation, traditional practices and environmental protection.

Early 1940's mountaineering clothing/equipment images wanted

Amber Rhodes is currently doing research on Sir Edmund Hillary's for a TV series covering his life from the 30's to the 70's. Part of this includes his early mountaineering days in the 1940's and she wonders if members have any photographs of that era. They do not have to be of Ed himself, but rather they are looking at the style of the clothes and equipment worn for

reference. Anything you can help her with would be greatly appreciated.

Email Amber: dreammachine86@hotmail.com

New book for sale - From Peak to Peak – by Grant Rawlinson

The inspiring true story of the first human-powered journey from the summit of Mt Ruapehu (2797m) in New Zealand to the summit of Aoraki / Mt Cook (3750m).

Can be purchased online through Amazon <http://www.amazon.com/>

Direct link: http://www.amazon.com/Peak-Human-Powered-Journey-Ruapehu-Zealand/dp/9810924267/ref=sr_1_1?ie=UTF8&qid=1416978921&sr=8-1&keywords=from+peak+to+peak+grant+rawlinson

BMC International Climbing Meet 2015

The BMC is pleased to announce that next year's BMC International Summer Climbing Meet will be located in the majestic Llanberis Pass of North Wales which has some of the best traditional climbing in Britain. New Zealand has been invited to put forward two representatives to attend this event. Preference will be given to people who have not attended a BMC International Meet before.

[Online application forms must be completed by 16 January \(contact Sam at NZAC if you wish to apply\)](#)

For more details on the event : <https://alpineclub.org.nz/event/2015/05/10/bmc-international-summer-climbing-meet>



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